

Microsoft PowerPoint

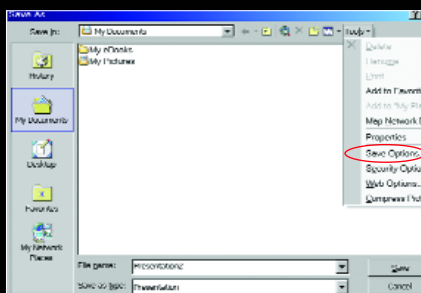
Facing flak for PowerPoint presentations acting up?
Read on for some solutions to easily avoidable glitches

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1. PowerPoint does not display fonts correctly

Reason: When used on a system other than the one on which the presentation was created, fonts may not display correctly. This can happen when you transfer or open a PowerPoint presentation file on another PC that does not contain the fonts that are installed on your system.

Solution: Embed TrueType fonts. When you save your presentation, use the 'Save As' command and in the 'Save As' dialog box, choose 'Embed TrueType Fonts' from the 'Tools' menu. In PowerPoint 2002 (also called PowerPoint XP), go to Tools>Save Options and check 'Embed TrueType fonts'.



When you are saving a presentation, from the Tools menu in 'Save As', choose to embed fonts

2. PowerPoint presentation file sizes bloat

Reason: Bitmaps, if you use them, take up a lot of space. And sometimes, presentation file sizes bloat for no apparent reason.

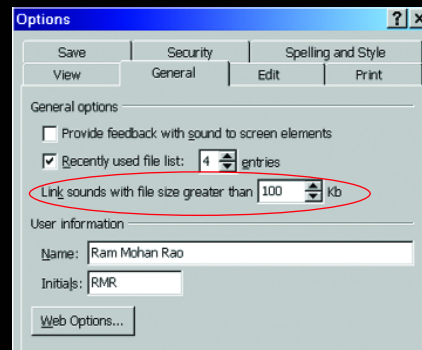
Solution: Try reducing the resolution of your bitmap images. For viewing on screen, bitmaps need not be more than 96 dpi. If the screen is the primary viewing medium, it is pointless to have higher-resolution bitmaps. Also, sometimes, as you are working on a presentation, the file might seem to get bigger for no reason. To eliminate this bloating, save the file using File>Save As and give the file a new

name. This can reduce the file size up to 50 per cent.

3. An audio clip can stop playing when you advance slides

Reason: This can happen due to the default settings in PowerPoint.

Solution: If you are using PowerPoint 2000, insert your sound file and go to Slide Show>Custom Animation. Check the



You can choose what sound file sizes to link and what sizes to embed

'Media' box that represents the sound file. Now click the 'Multimedia Settings' tab and tick the 'Play using animation order' box. Tick 'Continue Slide Show'. Specify the number of slides for which you want the sound to play. If your sound clip is for a short duration and you want it to play over and over again, click on 'More Options' and check the 'Loop until stopped' box.

A related problem is that your sound file does not play at all when you begin your presentation since sound clips that exceed a certain size do not get embedded into the slideshow. The solution is to change the default setting.

In PowerPoint 2002, go to Tools>Options, and in the 'General' tab, change the settings in the 'Link sounds with file size greater than'. Set this to a larger value.

4. The same background appears on every slide

Reason: PowerPoint automatically takes the background from the background master slide.

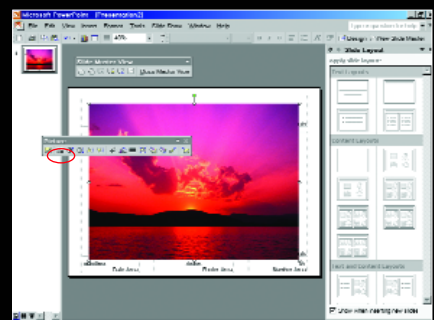
Solution: PowerPoint 2002 supports multiple background masters. Open the first slide and go to Insert>Slides From File. Browse to the second set of slides and choose the ones you want. In the lower left hand corner of the dialog box, tick the checkbox that says 'Keep Source Formatting'. The slides you add will keep their backgrounds.

For PowerPoint 2000 and earlier versions, from the 'Format' menu, select Background. Check the box that says 'Omit background items' and this will make the slide ignore the Slide Master's design. You can now apply whatever design you prefer to the slides.

5. Text is not very readable in front of a certain background

Reason: You may not notice it while editing your presentation in front of a screen, but dark text on a dark background does not read very well. If you want to keep your background, but would like to lighten it a little to improve readability, there is a way.

Solution: To create a light background for your presentation, open the slide master by going to View>Master>Slide Master and choose Insert>Picture>From File. Find and insert the image and resize it to fit the slide. With the image



'Washout' the background from the Picture toolbar to make text more readable

selected, choose 'Draw' on the Draw toolbar, then select Order and then 'Send to Back'. From the Picture toolbar, choose 'Color', then 'Washout'. Dark text will now show up clearly. □

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